• Low impact aerobic exercise as tolerated;
• Pharmacotherapy (e.g., non-narcotic analgesics, NSAIDs, muscle relaxants, neuroleptics, and narcotics).

When treatment for thermal destruction of the intraosseous basivertebral nerve is not covered:

Thermal destruction of the intraosseus basivertebral is considered not medically necessary or unproven for the following:

1. Skeletally immature (≤18 years old);
2. Severe cardiac or pulmonary compromise;
3. Active systemic infection or local infection at the intended treatment level;
4. Bleeding diathesis;
5. Pregnancy;
6. Primary radicular pain into the lower extremities (defined as nerve pain following a dermatomal distribution and that correlates with nerve compression on imaging);
7. Previous lumbar/lumbosacral spine surgery at the intended treatment level (with the exception of discectomy/laminectomy if performed >6 months prior to BVN nerve ablation and radicular pain resolved);
8. Primary symptomatic lumbar or lumbosacral spinal stenosis (defined as the presence of neurogenic claudication and confirmed by imaging);
9. Diagnosed osteoporosis (T-score of -2.5 or less), spine fragility fracture history, trauma/compression fracture at the intended treatment level, or spinal cancer;
10. Radiographic evidence of any of the following that correlates with predominant physical complaints:
    a) Lumbar/lumbosacral disc extrusion or protrusion >5mm at levels L3-S1;
    b) Lumbar/lumbosacral spondylolisthesis > 2mm at any level;
    c) Lumbar/lumbosacral spondylolysis at levels L3-S1;
    d) Lumbar/lumbosacral facet arthrosis/effusion correlated with facet-mediated pain at levels L3-S1.
11. Advanced generalized systemic disease that limits quality-of-life (QOL) improvements would require a statement of the objective of treatment in such cases;
12. Active, untreated substance abuse disorder.

Required Documentation

The scales used for measurement of pain and/or disability must be documented in the medical record. Acceptable scales include but are not limited to verbal rating scales, Numerical Rating Scale (NRS) and Visual Analog Scale (VAS) for pain assessment, and Pain Disability Assessment Scale (PDAS), Oswestry Disability Index (ODI), Oswestry Low Back Pain Disability Questionnaire (OSW), Quebec Back Pain